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FIREARM HOLSTERING SYSTEMS HAVING HOLSTER ATTACHMENT COMPONENTS THAT ARE PIVOTALLY CONNECTED TO FIREARM HOLSTERS

Abstract

Firearm holstering systems having holster attachment components that are pivotally connected to firearm holsters are disclosed herein. According to an aspect, a firearm holstering system includes a belt attachment component configured for attachment to a belt. The system also includes a holster attachment component that is pivotally connected to the belt attachment component. The holster attachment component is configured to pivotally connect to a firearm holster. The holster attachment component includes a locking mechanism configured to lock the firearm holster in at least two different positions with respect to the holster attachment component.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/560,885, filed Mar. 4, 2024, and titled FIREARM HOLSTERING SYSTEMS HAVING HOLSTER ATTACHMENT COMPONENTS THAT ARE PIVOTALLY CONNECTED TO FIREARM HOLSTERS, the disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety. [0002] The present application is related to a U.S. Design Patent Application titled FIREARM HOLSTERING SYSTEMS HAVING HOLSTER ATTACHMENT COMPONENTS THAT ARE PIVOTALLY CONNECTED TO FIREARM HOLSTERS, which is filed simultaneously herewith.

TECHNICAL FIELD
[0003] The presently disclosed subject matter relates generally to firearm equipment. Particularly, the presently disclosed subject matter relates to firearm holstering systems having holster attachment components that are pivotally connected to firearm holsters.
BACKGROUND
[0004] Various holsters have been developed to hold firearms. One particular type of holster is a drop leg holster, which is designed to hold a firearm securely on the thigh of a person. Typically, the drop leg holster is strapped around the person's thigh and also connected to a belt or harness around the person's waist. These types of holsters are often used by persons who require quick access to their firearms while also needing to maintain mobility, such as during tactical operations or outdoor activities.
[0005] There is a continuing need to provide improvements to holsters for firearms. In particular, there is a need to improve holsters to provide individuals with more convenient and quicker access to holstered firearms.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS
[0006] Having thus described the presently disclosed subject matter in general terms, reference will now be made to the accompanying Drawings, which are not necessarily drawn to scale, and wherein:
[0007] FIG. **1** is a front view of a firearm holstering system with a firearm holster removed in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure;
[0008] FIG. **2** is a front view of the firearm holstering system shown in FIG. **1** with a stand-off component at a maximum point of rotation in a clockwise direction;
[0009] FIG. **3** is a back view of the firearm holstering system shown in FIG. **1**;
[0010] FIG. **4** is a front view of the firearm holstering system shown in FIG. **1** but with a holster attached thereto;
[0011] FIG. **5** is a front view of the firearm holstering system shown in FIG. **1** but with a holster attached thereto;
[0012] FIG. **6** is a front view of the firearm holstering system shown in FIG. **4** but being worn by a person;

[0013] FIG. **7** is a front view of the firearm holstering system being worn by the person as shown in FIG. **6** but with the person in a sitting position;
[0014] FIG. **8** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system being worn by the seated person as shown in FIG. **7** but with the holstered firearm is rotated to face downward; and
[0015] FIG. **9** is an exploded, perspective view of the belt piece, the front panel, and the back panel assembly shown in FIG. **1**.

SUMMARY

[0016] The presently disclosed subject matter relates to firearm holstering systems having holster attachment components that are pivotally connected to firearm holsters. According to an aspect, a firearm holstering system includes a belt attachment component configured for attachment to a belt. The system also includes a holster attachment component that is pivotally connected to the belt attachment component. The holster attachment component is configured to pivotally connect to a firearm holster. The holster attachment component includes a locking mechanism configured to lock the firearm holster in at least two different positions with respect to the holster attachment component.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0017] The following detailed description is made with reference to the figures. Exemplary embodiments are described to illustrate the disclosure, not to limit its scope, which is defined by the claims. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize a number of equivalent variations in the description that follows.
[0018] Articles “a” and “an” are used herein to refer to one or to more than one (i.e. at least one) of the grammatical object of the article. By way of example, “an element” means at least one element and can include more than one element.
[0019] “About” is used to provide flexibility to a numerical endpoint by providing that a given value may be “slightly above” or “slightly below” the endpoint without affecting the desired result.
[0020] The use herein of the terms “including,” “comprising,” or “having,” and variations thereof is meant to encompass the elements listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional elements. Embodiments recited as “including,” “comprising,” or “having” certain elements are also contemplated as “consisting essentially of” and “consisting” of those certain elements.
[0021] Recitation of ranges of values herein are merely intended to serve as a shorthand method of referring individually to each separate value falling within the range, unless otherwise indicated herein, and each separate value is incorporated into the specification as if it were individually recited herein. For example, if a range is stated as between 1%-50%, it is intended that values such as between 2%-40%, 10%-30%, or 1%-3%, etc. are expressly enumerated in this specification. These are only examples of what is specifically intended, and all possible combinations of numerical values between and including the lowest value and the highest value enumerated are to be considered to be expressly stated in this disclosure.
[0022] Unless otherwise defined, all technical terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure belongs.
[0023] Firearm holstering systems disclosed herein can provide more convenient and quicker access to holstered firearms. In accordance with embodiments, firearm holsters disclosed herein are a type of drop leg holster having a holster attachment component that is pivotally connected to the firearm holster. This permits the firearm to be moved for more convenient and quick access whether the person is in a standing, seated or other position. Particularly, the holstered firearm can be moved to a preferred position for access by rotating it about the pivot and locking it in place at the preferred position.
[0024] FIG. **1** illustrates a front view of a firearm holstering system **100** with a firearm holster removed in accordance with embodiments of the present disclosure. The firearm holster is removed for convenience of illustration. Referring to FIG. **1**, the system **100** includes a belt piece **102** (i.e., a belt attachment component), a holster front panel **104** and back panel **106** (which together form a

holster attachment component, generally designated **108**), and a belt connector hub **110**. The belt connector hub **110** has a pivot mechanism that is pivotal about point **112** which permits the holster attachment component **108** (i.e., the assembly of the front panel **104** and the back panel **106**) to rotate with respect to the belt piece **102** about the pivot **112**. During use, the belt piece **102** is strapped to a person's waist, and the holster attachment component **110** is strapped to the person's leg. Thus, rotation about the pivot **112** of the belt connector hub **110** permits the holster attachment component **110** to move along with the person's thigh.

[0025] The belt piece **102** defines two apertures **114** and **116** through which a person's waist belt (not shown) can be threaded for holding the belt piece **102** to the wearer's waist. The holster front panel **104** defines apertures **118** and **120** through which a strap **122** is threaded for holding the belt connector hub **110** to the wearer's thigh. The strap **122** includes a tri-glide buckle **124** that enables the strap **122** to have an adjustable length. Alternatively, any other suitable mechanism may be utilized for enabling adjustable length. The strap **122** also include a side-release buckle with corresponding components **126**A and **126**B for securely connecting ends of the strap **122** together. Alternatively, any other suitable mechanism may be utilized for securely connecting ends of the strap **122** together.

[0026] The strap **122** can be made of a flexible material such as Nylon, leather, canvas, rubber, polyester, polypropylene, or any suitable material. The belt piece **102**, holster front panel **104**, holster back panel **106**, and/or other materials of the firearm holstering system **100** can be made of any suitable rigid material, such as metal or durable plastics (e.g., polycarbonate (PC), acrylonitrile butadiene styrene (ABS), polyethylene terephthalate (PET), polyvinyl chloride (PVC), polystyrene (PS), polyoxymethylene (POM, Acctal)).

[0027] With continuing reference to FIG. **1**, the holster attachment component **110** includes a stand-off component **128** configured for attachment of a holster (not shown). Particularly, the stand-off component **128** includes multiple posts **132**A, **132**B, and **132**C onto which the holster can suitably attach. For example, the holster may define multiple holes that align with the posts **132**A, **132**B, and **132**C for securing the holster to the posts **132**A, **132**B, and **132**C, such as by screwing. In this example, the holster attachment component **110** includes 3 posts in a triangular-shaped arrangement but alternatively may include any suitable number of posts of any suitable size and in any suitable arrangement.

[0028] The stand-off component **128** includes a locking mechanism having a rotation mechanism that can lock the firearm holster in various positions with respect to the holster attachment component **110**. Particularly, the rotation mechanism permits rotation of the firearm holster about a pivot **130**. The posts **132**A, **132**B, and **132**C can rotate about the pivot, and the holster can rotate accordingly. Thereby, the firearm (while in the holster) can be rotated to a desired position for convenient access whether the person is in a standing, seated or other position. Particularly, the holstered firearm can be moved to a preferred position for access by rotating it about the pivot **102** and locking it in place at the desired position.

[0029] The stand-off component **128** defines two abutments **134**A and **134**B that function to stop the rotation of the stand-off component **128** at the two maximum points of rotation. The abutment **134**A prevents the rotation of the stand-off component **128** at a maximum point of rotation in a clockwise direction. Conversely, the abutment **134**B prevents the rotation of the stand-off component **128** at a maximum point of rotation in a counter-clockwise direction. As shown in FIG. **1**, the stand-off component **128** is positioned at a location mid-way between the two maximum points of rotation.

[0030] FIG. **2** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** shown in FIG. **1** with the stand-off component **128** at a maximum point of rotation in a clockwise direction. Referring to FIG. **2**, a lower portion **200** of the stand-off component **128** is abutted against the abutment **134**A. In this position, the stand-off component **128** cannot be further rotated in the clockwise direction.

[0031] FIG. **3** illustrates a back view of the firearm holstering system **100** shown in FIG. **1**.

[0032] FIG. **4** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** shown in FIG. **1** but with a holster **400** attached thereto. Referring to FIG. **4**, the holster **400** includes a fastener **402** for holding a firearm in place once received into opening end **404** into its final holding place within the holster **400**. In this example, the fastener **402** is a snap fastener. Double arrow **406** indicates the two different directions of rotation of the holster **400** about pivot **130** shown in FIG. **1**. In FIG. **4**, the holster **400** is upright as in a position when the stand-off component **128** is in the position shown in FIG. **1**.
[0033] FIG. **5** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** shown in FIG. **1** but with a holster **400** attached thereto. Referring to FIG. **5**, the holster **400** is positioned with the opening **404** facing to the right as when the stand-off component **128** is in the position shown in FIG. **2**.
[0034] FIG. **6** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** shown in FIG. **4** but being worn by a person **600**. Referring to FIG. **6**, the person **600** is standing. Also, the holster is positioned upright in a ready position for the person **600** to access a holstered firearm **602**. The strap **122** is secured to the thigh of the person **600**. Also, the belt piece **102** is attached to a belt **604** of the person.
[0035] FIG. **7** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** being worn by the person **600** as shown in FIG. **6** but with the person **600** in a sitting position. Referring to FIG. **7**, the holstered firearm **602** is rotated in the same position as shown in FIG. **6** such that it faces forward. In contrast, FIG. **8** illustrates a front view of the firearm holstering system **100** being worn by the seated person **600** as shown in FIG. **7** but with the holstered firearm **602** is rotated to face downward.
[0036] FIG. **9** illustrates an exploded, perspective view of the belt piece **102**, the front panel **104**, and the back panel **106** assembly shown in FIG. **1**. Referring to FIG. **8**, the belt connector hub, includes a back cap **900** with a protrusion **902** for attachment to a front portion **904**. The back cap **900**, when attached to the front portion **904** can hold the belt piece **102** and permit rotation of the belt piece **102** with respect to the front panel **104** and and the back panel **106**.
[0037] With continuing reference to FIG. **9**, the front panel **104** and the back panel **106** can be attached together by an attachment assembly that includes screws **906**A and **906**B that can screw into threaded components **908**A and **908**B, respectively. The screws **906**A and **906**B can be screwed into threaded components **908**A and **908**B, respectively, for holding together the front panel **104** and the back panel **106**.
[0038] It is noted that the protrusion **802** of the back cap **900** can be selectively inserted into one of multiple apertures **910**A, **910**B, or **910**C to thereby adjust a height of the lower assembly of the front panel **104** and the back panel **106**, which holds the firearm and its holster.
[0039] While the embodiments have been described in connection with the various embodiments of the various figures, it is to be understood that other similar embodiments may be used, or modifications and additions may be made to the described embodiment for performing the same function without deviating therefrom. Therefore, the disclosed embodiments should not be limited to any single embodiment, but rather should be construed in breadth and scope in accordance with the appended claims.

Claims

1. A firearm holstering system comprising: a belt attachment component configured for attachment to a belt; and a holster attachment component that is pivotally connected to the belt attachment component, wherein the holster attachment component is configured to pivotally connect to a firearm holster, and wherein the holster attachment component comprises a locking mechanism configured to lock the firearm holster in at least two different positions with respect to the holster attachment component.
2. The firearm holstering system of claim 1, wherein the firearm holster is detachable from the

holster attachment component.
3. The firearm holstering system of claim 1, wherein the belt attachment component defines a plurality of apertures for holding to the belt.
4. The firearm holstering system of claim 1, further comprising a strap attached to the holster attachment component for attaching the holster attachment component to a person's leg.
5. The firearm holstering system of claim 4, wherein the strap includes a buckle for attachment of ends of the strap together.
6. The firearm holstering system of claim 4, wherein the holster attachment component defines a plurality of apertures for holding the strap.
7. The firearm holstering system of claim 1, wherein the locking mechanism comprises a rotation mechanism configured to hold the firearm holster to the holster attachment mechanism and to rotate the firearm holster with respect to the holster attachment mechanism.
8. The firearm holstering system of claim 7, wherein the at least two different positions comprise a first position and a second position, and wherein the rotation mechanism is configured to rotate the firearm holster to the first position, and configured to rotate the firearm holster to the second position.
9. The firearm holstering system of claim 8, wherein the holster attachment component defines at least one abutment that define a range of movement of the firearm holster between the first position and the second position.
10. The firearm holstering system of claim 1, wherein holster attachment mechanism comprises a stand-off component with an interface configured to attachment to and detachment from the firearm holster.
11. A method of holstering a firearm, the method comprising: providing a firearm holstering system comprising: a belt attachment component configured for attachment to a belt; and a holster attachment component that is pivotally connected to the belt attachment component, wherein the holster attachment component is configured to pivotally connect to a firearm holster, and wherein the holster attachment component comprises a locking mechanism configured to lock the firearm holster in at least two different positions with respect to the holster attachment component; and rotating the holster attachment component.
12. The method of claim 11, wherein the firearm holster is detachable from the holster attachment component.
13. The method of claim 11, wherein the belt attachment component defines a plurality of apertures for holding to the belt.
14. The method of claim 11, further comprising a strap attached to the holster attachment component for attaching the holster attachment component to a person's leg.
15. The method of claim 14, wherein the strap includes a buckle for attachment of ends of the strap together.
16. The method of claim 14, wherein the holster attachment component defines a plurality of apertures for holding the strap.
17. The method of claim 11, wherein the locking mechanism comprises a rotation mechanism configured to hold the firearm holster to the holster attachment mechanism and to rotate the firearm holster with respect to the holster attachment mechanism.
18. The method of claim 17, wherein the at least two different positions comprise a first position and a second position, and wherein the rotation mechanism is configured to rotate the firearm holster to the first position, and configured to rotate the firearm holster to the second position.
19. The method of claim 18, wherein the holster attachment component defines at least one abutment that define a range of movement of the firearm holster between the first position and the second position.
20. The method of claim 11, wherein holster attachment mechanism comprises a stand-off component with an interface configured to attachment to and detachment from the firearm holster.